HILCHOT SHABBAT

Can You Salt Your Salad on Shabbat? Pickling, Crushing & Mashing

Given Thursday 22 October 2026 · Hilchot Shabbat I Siman 321:2-12

Sefer: Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim, Siman 321 (סימן שכ"א)

Seifim covered: 2–6 (pickling), 7, 9 and 12 (tochen). Seif 1 is held back to be learned with the rest of tochen.

Topic: The rabbinic prohibition of pickling: salt-water solutions, salting many pieces together, and salting in order to pickle. Rashi (דומה לעיבוד) versus the Rambam (דומה לבישול). Practical questions: salads, sugar on fruit, vinegar, and putting half-pickled food back in the brine. Then the opening principles of **מלאכת טוחן**: the back of an instrument, **אין טוחן אחר טוחן**, cutting **דק דק**, and **אין טוחן אלא בגידולי קרקע**.

Schedule note: This was the first Hilchot Shabbat shiur after the chagim, on Thursday, 6:15–7:15pm.

Where We Are

- **The break.** Hilchot Shabbat paused for about three months:
- before **Tisha B'Av** we learned the Rambam's Mishneh Torah on **Hilchot Ta'aniyot** and **Tisha B'Av**;
- in **Elul/Tishrei** we learned the Rambam on **Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur and Sukkot**.

We have learned these sections in the Shulchan Aruch before, but never in the Rambam. *"I think that was very meaningful."*

- **The project.** We have been learning through the Shulchan Aruch on Shabbat for **over two and a half, almost three years**:
- **Simanim 242–301:** the positive aspects of Shabbat;
- **Simanim 301–320:** the melachot. **Siman 320** was completed at the end of the summer term.
- **Major melachot covered so far:**
- **hotza'ah** (carrying) and **muktzeh**;
- **building and demolishing**;
- **trapping, hunting and killing**;
- **tying and untying**;
- **making a tent**;
- **cooking** (bishul);
- **borer** (selecting);
- **squeezing** (sechita), among others.
- **What's left.** The simanim run to **344**, and the melachot really conclude around **340**. Most of the coming simanim are short, so **Siman 321 is the last major one.**

Overview of Siman 321

Seifim	Topic
1	Tochen. Saved for the end of the tochen section.
2–6	**Pickling** (rabbinic: similar to tanning or to cooking)
7–12	**Tochen**: grinding, crushing, mashing, cutting fine
13	A separate matter
14–end	**Lash**: kneading

Three major topics in this siman:

1. **Lash (kneading).** One of the most complicated melachot to understand. *"So many people don't understand the principles of lash, and therefore make mistakes."* It is only three seifim in the Shulchan Aruch and highly complicated, but once you understand the principles and go back to the Gemara, *"it all makes total sense."* We will learn it towards the end of the siman.
2. **Tochen.** Crushing, mashing, grinding and cutting.
3. **Pickling.** This is where we start tonight.

Part One — Pickling (כבישה): Seifim 2–6

Introduction: The Prohibitions

The Gemara gives **two explicit prohibitions**:

1. **Making a salt-water solution** (מי מלח).
2. **Salting many pieces together** of vegetables that are **normally pickled**, such as cucumbers, onions and cabbage. Think of **חמוצים**, the cans and tubs of pickled vegetables.

A **third** prohibition (below) follows from these: **salting even one piece in order to pickle it.**

Why? A מחלוקת ראשונים

It is definitely a **rabbinic** prohibition. The question is what the Chachamim modelled it on.

Rashi and most Rishonim: דומה לעיבוד, similar to tanning

- **Me'abed** (tanning) is one of the 39 melachot:
- The **first 11** melachot are the process of making the dyes: the land, ploughing, through to kneading and baking.
- The **next set** deal with animals: trapping, slaughtering, **skinning (מפשיט)** and **tanning (מעבד)**. One of the roofs of the Mishkan was made of hides.
- **Salting is an essential part of the tanning process.** The Rabbi read up on this online before the shiur. Salt both begins the tanning and makes the hide durable for storage.
- The Gemara says explicitly **אין עיבוד באוכלין**: there is no tanning with food, so there is **no Torah melacha** here.

- Even so, salt **completely changes the texture** of the food (think of a cucumber becoming a pickle), just as salting a hide changes its texture and makes it durable. So the Chachamim forbade pickling **rabbinically**, as a corollary of tanning.

The Rambam: דומה לבישול, similar to cooking

The Rambam was presumably not happy linking hides with food. *Which melacha would you tie it to instead?*

Robert: *"Isn't it a way of making food edible? So you might say it's some sort of cooking."*

The Rabbi: *"Exactly, perfect, very good."*

- The Rambam says salting makes food edible and is **דומה לבישול**, similar to cooking.
- Of course it isn't actual bishul: there is no fire, and as we learned in **Siman 318**, fire is essential to bishul. But by changing the texture through salt, you are cooking in a sense, on a rabbinic level.
- The Rabbi finds this **the more straightforward explanation**.

Mark: *"I read somewhere that salt gives off heat, so from that point of view that's where the cooking occurs."*

The Rabbi: *"Interesting, I never thought of it like that."* He had understood the Rambam as comparing the **change in texture** (uncooked → cooked; unpickled → pickled). The heat may also be part of it. *"Maybe it's a combination."*

Follow-up later in the shiur: a participant looked it up. Dissolving **table salt (sodium chloride)** in water is **not exothermic**. Other salts (calcium chloride, magnesium chloride) do give off heat, but we don't put those in food. **Himalayan salt** is still sodium chloride, and **kosher/coarse salt** is just a coarser grain. Perhaps older sources didn't know the science, or perhaps the heat comes from salt reacting with the proteins in a hide during tanning. That part of the tanning process does involve some heat, which may be where the idea came from.

The Shulchan Aruch brings both

Seif 2 gives **Rashi's** reason (משום דמי לעיבוד), and **Seif 3** gives the **Rambam's** (מפני שהוא כמבשל). We have seen before that the Shulchan Aruch sometimes combines reasons when it finds both convincing. There are few, if any, clear practical differences between them.

Robert's question: a decree on a decree?

Robert: *I can understand why you can't pickle. But why can't you add salt to water? Pickling itself is only rabbinic, so banning the salt water looks like a second derabbanan on top of the first.*

The Rabbi: It isn't a **gezeirah l'gezeirah**. This is **הכל גזירה אחת**: it was **all one enactment**, made in one go. When the Chachamim banned pickling, they banned the **things that make up pickling**, such as salt-water solutions, together with it.

Seif 2 — Making salt water

אין עושים מי מלח הרבה ביחד לתת לתוך הכבשים משום דמי לעיבוד. אבל יכול לעשות ממנו מעט לתת לתוך התבשיל. אם נתן לתוכו שני שלישי מלח, אסור לעשות ממנו אפילו מעט.

Translation: One may not make **a large amount** of salt water to put into pickles, because it resembles tanning. One may make **a small amount** to put into a dish. If **two-thirds** of it is salt, even a small amount is forbidden.

Solution	Ruling
Two-thirds salt (extremely salty)	**Forbidden** in any quantity. Something that salty must be part of pickling.
Less than two-thirds, **large quantity**	**Forbidden**. A large amount suggests pickling, even if you only dip and eat.
Less than two-thirds, **small quantity**	**Permitted**. It is part of eating (צורך אכילה).

What is "a little" and what is "a lot"?

- The logic: a small amount is clearly for **dipping and eating**, while a large amount suggests you're **coming to pickle**.
- The **Shulchan Aruch HaRav** (the first Lubavitcher Rebbe, about 250 years ago) wrote that he doesn't know the difference between מעט and הרבה. Others have tried to give measurements.
- **The Rabbi:** *"The answer I take with all of this is very simple: common sense."* It depends on the family, the context, the se'udah and what's going on. *"You can't define these things."* (The same issue comes back in tochen tonight.)

Practical case: salt water for karpas at the Seder

- *"We Syrians use lemon water,"* but **Ashkenazim**, and some **Sefardim**, use **salt water**.
- A Seder salt water won't be two-thirds salt, so that isn't the issue. But if you have **50 guests** and need a large amount for bowls across the table, that is a **large quantity**.
- That's why the **Rema** writes in Hilchot Pesach that the salt water should be **made beforehand**.

Seif 3 — Salting many pieces together

אסור למלוח חתיכות צנון ד' או ה' ביחד, מפני שהוא ככובש כבשים, והכובש אסור מפני שהוא כמבשל. אלא מטבל כל אחת לבדה ואוכלה. אבל ביצים מותר למלחן.

- You may not salt **four or five pieces together** of radish (or cucumber, cabbage, onion, or anything normally pickled). Done together, **it looks like the start of pickling**, even if you intend to eat it immediately.
- **Two or three pieces** may be salted and eaten.
- Here the Shulchan Aruch gives the **Rambam's** reason, **כמבשל**.

  אלא מטבל כל אחת לבדה ואוכלה: dip each piece individually, either into an existing solution or into one made under the conditions of Seif 2.
- **The poskim:** the Shulchan Aruch's **"dip"** is just **אורחא דמילתא**, the normal way of saying it. According to the Shulchan Aruch it is **equally fine to salt two or three pieces**.

  אבל ביצים מותר למלחן: eggs are just the Gemara's example. **Anything not normally pickled may be salted.**

The Ashkenazi minhag (Magen Avraham)

- Ashkenazim recorded a minhag **never to salt vegetables on Shabbat at all**. If you want salt on a vegetable, **dip the vegetable into the salt**, so the question never arises.
- **A parallel:** the Magen Avraham also records the Ashkenazi minhag **not to bathe even in cold water on Shabbat** (because of squeezing, heating and other concerns). That is one of the reasons Ashkenazim don't swim on Shabbat.

- **Me'ikar hadin**, for **Sefardim**, swimming in a **swimming pool** on Shabbat is permitted under certain conditions. **Not the sea.**
- *"Unless you know those conditions, don't do it."*
- **For Sefardim:** you may dip your vegetables into salt or a salt-water solution, **or** salt two or three pieces.

The third prohibition: salting in order to pickle

Even one piece, if you're salting it to pickle it, is forbidden. This applies even on Friday night for Shabbat afternoon.

The Rabbi's own example: you finish a tub of **chamutzim**, and a strong solution is left at the bottom. During the week he cuts up **carrots or cabbage** and drops them in. After a day or two they're pickled again, not as strong as the original but pickled. **You can't do this on Shabbat, even with a single piece**, because that is pickling.

Summary: the three rabbinic prohibitions

#	Prohibition	What is permitted
1	**Making salt water**	Only a **small** amount, **less than two-thirds** salt
2	**Salting many pieces together** (4–5+) of normally-pickled vegetables	Salt **2–3** pieces, or **dip** each piece (Ashkenazim: dip only)
3	**Salting even one piece in order to pickle it**	Not permitted

All three are **rabbinic**, rooted in either **me'abed** (Rashi) or **bishul** (Rambam).

Practical Questions

1. Salting a salad

Suppose the salad is **cucumbers, carrots and cabbage**, all commonly pickled. Based on what we've learned, you **can't put salt on that by itself**.

The halacha: the salt must come **together with oil or lemon**.

- Some say to put the **oil in first**.
- What's clear: if you dress the salad **in one go** (salt, then a second later oil, then lemon), that is fine. *"I don't do a lot in the kitchen, but I do know how to spice a salad: salt, oil and lemon."*
- **Salt alone**, for a salty salad, is a problem.
- If you **salted it, went out to a friend, and came back** to add the oil and lemon, that is **asur**.

Which vegetables count?

- **Red tomatoes** aren't pickled. **Chacham Ovadia** writes specifically about **green tomatoes**, which *are* pickled: be careful not to salt them.
- **A normal mixed salad** (red tomatoes, cucumbers, carrots, lettuce) combines pickled and unpickled items.

> **דומה** you may **put the salt on by itself**. You're salting **a salad as a whole**, and that is **not** ,**לענות דעתי** **לכובש כבשים**. *"The whole salad is clearly a salad".*

- Some disagree, because part of the salad is commonly pickled.
- If the salad is **primarily commonly-pickled vegetables**, put the salt on **together with oil or lemon**, not salt alone.

2. Marie: sugar on fruit

Marie: *Instead of salting, may you sweeten fruit on Shabbat, putting sugar on it and leaving it to absorb?*

The Rabbi: *"That's so funny you ask that."* **Chacham Ovadia** was asked exactly this, about putting **sugar on strawberries**.

- **Permitted:**
- It is **not bishul**: **fruit isn't cooked**, vegetables are. We find the same principle in Hilchot Bishul.
- It is **not ibud**: fruit isn't "tanned".
- **Caveat: it must be for Shabbat.** You may do it **Friday night for Shabbat afternoon**, but not **Shabbat afternoon to eat on Sunday**, since that is **preparing for after Shabbat**. For Shabbat itself, it is permitted *"100%, according to all opinions."*

3. Robert: other pickling agents, such as vinegar

Robert: *What about pickling with things other than salt, like vinegar or lemon? If the reason is tanning, you would never use vinegar on a hide.*

- **The Rabbi:** the Chachamim made a **comprehensive ban on pickling**, whatever does the pickling. Tanning is only Rashi's account of why.
- The **Mishnah Berurah (ס"ק ח')** states explicitly that **vinegar** is included.
- So **putting garlic into vinegar to pickle it** is the same problem.
- **Lemon juice alone doesn't pickle. Salting is the main part** of the pickling process, and that was the Chachamim's concern. So squeezing lemon onto food isn't comparable.

4. Chacham Ovadia: אין כובש אחר כובש?

The case: you pickled vegetables during the week and serve them on Shabbat. At the end of the meal you realise some are **only half pickled**. They should have stayed in the solution longer. **Can you put them back in?** (Chacham Ovadia also asks whether something already pickled in salt may go into vinegar, or vice versa.)

If pickling is like…	Then…
Bishul (Rambam)	In bishul there is a **מחלוקת ראשונים**, as we saw in **Siman 318**: the **Rosh** holds that once food is **מאכל בן דרוסאי** (half-cooked, barely edible), further cooking is **not** Torah bishul. With bishul **we're machmir** because it's a **safek de'oraita**. Pickling is **derabbanan**, so we could say **אין כובש אחר כובש** and put it back.
Ibud (Rashi)	**Who says there's an אין עיבוד אחר עיבוד?** Who says half-tanned leather may be finished?

Chacham Ovadia's conclusion: uncertain, so **better not to** put it back.

Seif 4 — Dipping individually, then gathering

יש מי שכתב שמותר לטבול כמה חתיכות צנון אחת אחת לבדה ולהניחם יחד לפניהם כדי לאוכלם זו אחר זו.

- This comes from the **Terumat HaDeshen**.
- Dip **one piece**, put it down; dip the second, put it next to it; then the third, fourth and fifth. Then eat them.
- Even though the end result is **4–5 salted pieces in front of you, this is permitted.**
- **Why:** the Chachamim forbade **the act of salting (מליחה)**, and you're **dipping**.
- The **Mishnah Berurah** discusses whether the pieces may touch, and says they should be **kept separate**.

Seif 5 — Salting cooked meat or eggs to keep them

אסור למלוח בשר מבושל או ביצה מבושלת להניחה.

- You may not salt cooked meat or a cooked egg **להניחה**, **to preserve it for later**. **Preserving** falls under the same prohibition.
- **What does להניחה mean?**
- Some poskim say **even a later meal on the same day**.
- **The Rabbi's understanding of the Shulchan Aruch:** it means **for later on**, i.e. for a long time. That is what makes it pickling or preserving.

Robert: *Surely "for later" must mean later in the same day. For a later day it's already forbidden as **hachana**, preparing for another day.*

The Rabbi: The **hachana** prohibition is a **very minor rabbinic prohibition**, not comparable to the others, so it isn't what this seif is about.

Robert: *I didn't know there were different levels of rabbinic prohibitions. Isn't the punishment the same, e.g. lashes (מכת מרדות)?*

The Rabbi: *"Of course there are different levels."* How can you compare a **מלאכה שאינה צריכה לגופה** to **hachana**? Incomparable. **Makat mardut** isn't for every rabbinic matter, and **you definitely wouldn't get it for hachana**. The poskim weigh one derabbanan against another when one must be violated, considering how close each is to the de'oraita, among other factors. *"That's a whole shiur for another time."*

Seif 6 — Beans and lentils

אין למלוח ביחד הרבה פולין ועדשים.

This is another example: you may not salt **many beans or lentils together**, because these are commonly pickled.

Summary of Pickling (Seifim 2–6)

- **The prohibition is rabbinic.** Rashi says it resembles **tanning**; the Rambam says it resembles **cooking**. The Shulchan Aruch brings **both**.
- **Two Gemara prohibitions:**

1. making salt water (small amounts under two-thirds salt are permitted);
2. salting many pieces together (2–3 pieces or dipping is permitted).

- **A third prohibition:** salting even **one** piece **in order to pickle** it.
- **Practical rulings:**
- Salads: salt **with oil or lemon**. A mixed salad may be salted alone, according to the Rabbi.
- Sugar on fruit is **permitted** for Shabbat.

- **Vinegar** is included in the ban.
- Half-pickled food: **better not** to put it back in the brine.
- Dipping pieces one by one and then gathering them is **permitted**.
- You may not salt cooked meat or eggs **to preserve them**.

Part Two — מלאכת טוחן (Grinding / Crushing): Seifim 7–12

Tochen runs from **Seif 7 to Seif 12** inclusive, plus **Seif 1**, which we'll come back to at the end. We made a start tonight with about 20 minutes left.

What is Tochen?

- **Tochen is the ninth melacha.** It is still within the **first 11**, the process of **making the dyes**. We ploughed, harvested and threshed, then selected the good seeds and removed the bad (**borer**) and sifted. Now the seeds must become a paste:
- **9. Tochen**: crush the seeds;
- **10. Lash**: knead them (later in this siman);
- **11. Bishul / Ofeh**: cook or bake them (already learned).
- **Three forms of tochen are definitely forbidden from the Torah:**
- **grinding**, e.g. salt;
- **crushing**, e.g. pepper;
- **mashing**, e.g. a banana.

Principle 1 — A שינוי גדול: the back of an instrument

The normal rule: a melacha done **with a shinui** (an unusual way) is **rabbinically forbidden**, though not de'oraita. The classic example is writing with your left hand.

The exception: there are **three places** in the melachot of Shabbat where the Chachamim **permitted** a Torah melacha done with a **שינוי גדול**, a very great deviation. The Rabbi remembers two offhand; he needs to think about the third. **Two of them are in this siman: tochen** (now) and **lash** (later).

- The term **שינוי גדול** is the language of the **Acharonim**. It isn't found in the Gemara, and the Rabbi doesn't know if it's in the Rishonim. *"This is at least my understanding. There may be another."*
- **What counts as a שינוי גדול for tochen:** crushing with the **back of an instrument**, meaning the **handle** of a knife, fork or spoon, rather than the working end. This is so unusual that the Chachamim permitted it, because it is **needed for eating**.
- **Normal grinding instruments:**
- a mortar;
- a **cheese grater**;
- **vegetable/carrot graters**.

All of these are forbidden for tochen. **Most graters, certainly specialised vegetable graters, are muktzeh. Exception: a cheese grater is not muktzeh.** We'll learn why later.

Practical: you want to make **banana purée for a baby** or **mash an avocado**. Mashing normally would be **forbidden from the Torah**, with some nuance we'll discuss. But you may **mash it with the back of a fork or knife** and eat it.

Seif 7 — Pepper

מותר לדוך פלפלין אפילו הרבה ביחד, והוא שידוכם בקתא של סכין ובקערה.

- You may crush peppers, **even many together**, using the **handle of a knife**, **onto a plate**.
- **"Onto a plate":** there are instruments you grind **with** and instruments you grind **into** (a mortar bowl, a grater's base). **Neither** specialised kind may be used. A normal plate is fine.

Side point: crushing pepper inside a cloth (the Maharshal)

The case: you put a lot of pepper in a cloth, wrap it up, and crush it with the back of a knife. Why not?

- **The Maharshal** (about 500 years ago) first said **no**, because of **מוליד ריח**, creating a new smell in an item. We'll learn this properly later.
- You **may** spray perfume or deodorant **on your body** on Shabbat.
- You may **not** spray perfume **on your clothes**, or a **lavender spray on your pillow** before bed. The fabric takes on a new smell, which the Chachamim forbade as making something new.
- Here, the cloth would absorb the pepper's smell.
- **The Maharshal later retracted** and permitted it. There are several possible reasons:

  the smell is an inevitable side-effect (psik reisha), and the prohibition it touches **פסיק רישא בדרבנן מותר:** (מוליד ריח) is only rabbinic.

2. Following the **Maggid Mishneh**'s line we've seen before: the result is so far removed from the act that it isn't even a psik reisha. *"If you got that, you got that. If not, don't worry about it."*

- **Bottom line:** you may crush pepper in a cloth if you're doing it **to crush**, not to scent the cloth. **If you intend to give the cloth the smell, it is forbidden.**

Seif 7 (continued) — Salt

אין כותשין מלח במדוך של עץ, אבל מרסקו ביד של סכין או בעץ הפרור, ואינו חושש.

This is the same principle, with salt instead of pepper. You may not crush salt with a specialised **wooden (or stone) pestle**. You **may** crush it with the **handle of a knife** or a spoon, *"and there's no concern."*

Principle 2 — אין טוחן אחר טוחן: no grinding after grinding

Rema: ודוקא מלח הגס, אבל מלח שהיה דק מתחלה ונתבשל ונעשה פתיתין, מותר לחותכן בסכין כמו שחותך הפת.

- The ban applies only to **originally coarse salt**, salt that has **never been processed**. Salt that was **fine to begin with** and then cooked into flakes may be cut with a knife, **just like cutting bread**.
- **The principle:** something that was **already ground** may be ground, crushed or mashed **again**.
- **Bread:** flour was ground from wheat and then reconstituted into bread or a cracker. So you may **crumble bread into tiny, tiny pieces**.
- These first two principles are **unanimous and accepted**.

Salt today:

- **Most salt today has already been processed**, so it's already been ground. *"Someone can check this."*
- Very **coarse, natural salts** would still be a problem.
- **Himalayan salt grinders:**

- These are **forbidden**: at least **rabbinically**, since you're using a **specialised instrument**.
- Whether it's **de'oraita** depends on a principle still to come: whether you're grinding **for immediate consumption**.
- **The grinder itself is muktzeh.** You can't even touch or move it on Shabbat.
- **Lumps in ordinary salt** (e.g. water got in): you **may crush them**. The salt was already ground, so **אין טוחן אחר טוחן**.

Seif 12 — Cutting very fine: the fourth form of tochen

The Rabbi jumped ahead to Seif 12 before Seif 9, because Seif 9 only makes sense after it.

המחתך הירק דק דק חייב משום טוחן.

- We had three forms so far: grinding, crushing and mashing. Some **Rishonim** (the Rabbi thinks the **Rashba**) understood the Gemara to mean that **cutting into very small pieces** is **also** tochen, a **fourth form**.
- So even without grating, crushing or mashing, **cutting a vegetable into minuscule pieces** makes you **חייב משום טוחן**.
- **Practical:** you can't make a salad cut into **tiny pieces**.
- *"I remember **Rabbi Falk in Gateshead** telling us you can't make an **Israeli salad** on Shabbat."*
- The Rabbi isn't sure: an Israeli salad (finely diced tomatoes and cucumbers) is quite small. *Is it דק דק?*

What is דק דק?

- The **Rishonim** already write: **שיעור דקותו לא נודע לנו**, *"we do not know the measure of its fineness."*
- So the **Beit Yosef** writes: **don't cut too small**, since that might be the size meant.
- **What's clear: regular small pieces are fine**. The prohibition is about **very** small pieces.
- *"Whatever each person thinks is very small."* But you definitely **cannot cut a carrot into very, very small pieces**.

Seif 9 — Cutting cooked meat finely

מותר לחתוך בשר מבושל או צלי דק דק בסכין.

You may cut **cooked or roasted meat** (and cooked fish) **into extremely small pieces** with a knife. *We just said דק דק is tochen, so why is this permitted?*

Two factors combine:

(a) אין טוחן אלא בגידולי קרקע. Tochen applies only to **things that grow from the ground**.

- **Cheese** doesn't grow from the ground, so you **may crush or grate cheese** on Shabbat. (Mushrooms were a *"bad example"*: they are subject to the same machloket.)
- What about **meat, chicken and eggs**? This is a **מחלוקת ראשונים**. Some Rishonim say that since **animals feed from the ground**, they and their products count as **גידולי קרקע**. That would include eggs, because chickens feed from the ground.

(b) Tochen applies only to inedible food. There was a **major opinion, though not the halacha**, based on the Gemara's case of **סילקא**. What exactly סילקא is is unclear, just as with the Rosh Hashanah simanim. On this view, tochen means making something **edible** that wasn't, e.g. something too large to eat. If a food is **already edible** (a carrot, for example), crushing or cutting it small adds nothing. **We don't hold this way.**

Together: cooked meat is **already edible** (b), and it **doesn't grow from the ground** (a), even though some Rishonim count animals as ground-produce. **The combination permits it.**

Practical:

Food	Ruling
Cooked meat / chicken / fish	May be cut **very fine**, **mashed** or **puréed**, e.g. for a baby
Cooked eggs	May be **mashed in the normal way**, with no need for the back of a knife: they are cooked (edible) **and** come from an animal, not directly from the ground
Cheese	**Permitted** outright: it doesn't grow from the ground, so no combination is needed
Egg + mayonnaise	A **separate question**: that is **lash** (kneading), later in Siman 321

Summary of Tochen So Far

Three principles of tochen learned tonight:

#	Principle	Practical result
1	**A שינוי גדול** (the back or handle of an instrument) is **permitted** for any grinding	Mash banana or avocado, crush pepper or salt, with the back of a fork or knife, onto a plate
2	**אין טוחן אחר טוחן**	Bread may be crumbled; processed salt and salt lumps may be crushed
3	**אין טוחן אלא בגידולי קרקע**	Cheese is permitted. Cooked meat, chicken, fish and eggs may be mashed or cut fine, by combination with the "already edible" view.

Also: cutting vegetables **דק דק** is tochen (Seif 12). Regular small pieces are fine; *"very small"* is unknown, so don't go too fine.

Coming Up

- **More tochen:**
- further important principles and **practical examples**;
- **grinding for immediate consumption** (relevant to whether a salt grinder is de'oraita);
- why a **cheese grater isn't muktzeh**;
- the **remaining seifim** and **Seif 1**.
- **Then lash (kneading):** *"one of the most complicated melachot"*, Seifim 14–end, including the second **שינוי גדול** heter.
- At the end, the Rabbi asked everyone to stay on so he could discuss **options for learning in the coming year**.

B'Ezrat Hashem

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